



**Woldgate
School**

Of great merit, character & value

Part of the Family



Wonder
Learning Partnership
Educate | Empower | Engage | Enrich

Boundless WONDER

ISSUE 4

A Term Full of Opportunities

This term brings a range of exciting enrichment activities. Pupils can join the new Debating Club, while creative pupils may enter the East Riding Poetry Competition, the teacher desk-organiser design challenge, or the Jamie Oliver Youth Prize for young photographers. Budding chefs can take part in Springboard FutureChef, and linguists in years 8 and 9 are invited to the Translatathon. Pupils can also explore new historical topics through Oxford's Historia Lectures, and year 9 pupils are encouraged to enter the Perse Aristotelian Award essay competition.

The Debating Club

Sixth Form and Upper School pupils are invited to join the new Debating Club, to enrich their learning beyond the classroom.

The club will follow a nationally recognised format, enabling pupils to develop their skills in structured debate and, if they wish, to compete in formal debating competitions. Pupils who choose to join the Debating Club will be encouraged to research in depth, articulate their views with clarity, and engage critically with alternative perspectives. The programme is designed to foster intellectual curiosity and independence of thought while building confidence in public speaking and reasoned argument.

Debates will cover a broad spectrum of challenging and contemporary issues, including politics, global affairs, ethics, technology, and matters of local and national interest such as the use of green belt land. This initiative aims to cultivate analytical thinking and informed discussion among our pupils, equipping them with skills that will serve them well in both their academic and future professional lives.

Please contact Ms Shepherd for more details.

Design a desk organiser

Designers can now enter a 3D-printing challenge to create a teacher desk organiser for the new school.

'Onshape' software is industry-standard software and we have a 3D printing competition running, to design a teacher desk organiser for the new school. The winning design will be produced and a prize will be awarded.

The Jamie Oliver Youth Prize

If you are an aspiring photographer aged 17 or under, this competition was made for you.

We are looking for the best photographs that tell a food story. It could be of your grandmother's special pie, or a baker making the bread you love, or your friend cooking spaghetti. The food story you tell is up to you and we can't wait to see what you come up with.

Entries will be submitted in two age groups, 12 and under and 13-17.

Your photos will be judged by Jamie Oliver, James Verity, Creative Director, the Jamie Oliver Group, David Loftus, Chair of Judges, World Food Photography Awards.

Prizes

The Winners of both age groups (12 & under, 13-17) will be invited to attend the Jamie Oliver Headquarters, London, accompanied by a parent/guardian. If required, a contribution of maximum £500 per winner will be made towards travel and accommodation (T&Cs apply).

They will also be invited, with one parent/guardian to the Awards Evening at the Mall Galleries, London where they will be presented with a trophy. Their winning image, along with the runner up images, will be displayed in a dedicated Jamie Oliver Youth Prize section of the exhibition.

For further details please speak to Mrs Postill.



[World Food
Photography
Awards 2026](#)



'My Universe'

**EAST RIDING
LIBRARIES**

East Riding Poetry Competition

The East Riding Festival of Words poetry competition is now open for entries with theme of 'My universe'. Your universe can be whatever you like - a sunny spot in your garden, a favourite memory, or your idea of a perfect world. You have the whole universe to play with...

Entries will be judged by a panel of published Yorkshire poets, led by James Nash. Poems are submitted anonymously, so each entry is judged on its own merits. Winners will be invited to read their poems at a special event.

Poems are submitted to the judging panel anonymously, so each entry is judged on its own merits.

Winners will be invited to read their poems at a special event.

Closes: 10 January 2026

Enter at: <https://www.eastridinglibraries.co.uk/festival-of-words/poetry-competition>

Culinary Competition



Springboard FutureChef is a schools-based programme across the UK that supports the development of key life skills, while inspiring young people to pursue an exciting career within the world of hospitality. They support pupils to build industry based culinary skills and knowledge, as well as connecting teachers and pupils with industry professionals.

The Springboard FutureChef competition is now the biggest school culinary competition in the UK, celebrating talent and adding to our long list of successful alumni.

For further details, please speak to Mrs Saltmer

Historia Lectures

A series of super-curricular lectures from the University of Oxford's Faculty of History

Aimed at pupils currently studying for A-levels or equivalent, these lectures are designed to introduce you to new and engaging historical topics and periods. Lecture subjects are drawn from current DPhil candidate research.

Live sessions include an introductory lecture, Q&A and suggested reading materials to help you explore the topic further. Join the mailing list to receive weekly links to the live lectures throughout the Spring Term. The 2026 series will launch in January 2026.

Historia Lectures are recorded and we have an amazing archive of lectures available on our website as a resource for pupils.

[Explore past lectures via the links on this page and find your new favourite topic!](#)



The Hull and East Riding Cross-phase Translatathon

The school will be entering this competition which will run throughout the year.

The aim is for pupils in Years 8 and 9 to practise and improve their vocabulary, pronunciation and memory skills in the target language (French or Spanish). Words and phrases have been selected according to frequency, and for preparation for GCSE

Teams will comprise 4 members and prizes will be 4 x £20 Amazon vouchers for each member of the overall winning team and 4 x £10 vouchers for each member of the overall runner up team. **Please contact Mrs Burden for more details.**

2025-26 Perse Aristotelian Award essay competition launched

Following a record number of entries last year, The Perse is inviting Year 9 pupils across the UK and beyond to once again display their intellectual curiosity with the launch of the 2025-26 Aristotelian Award.

The popular essay competition is divided into two sections – arts/humanities and sciences – with a choice of five essay titles in each category ready to challenge their research skills.

Cash prizes are on offer with the winners of each category receiving £70. Four pupils in each category will be highly commended and receive £20 each.

Perse Head of Research Hazel Knight said: “We’re excited to announce the launch of our yearly Aristotelian Award and welcome Year 9 pupils internationally to engage with our collection of thought-provoking questions, choosing one that captures their curiosity.



THE PERSE
SCHOOL
CAMBRIDGE

“Pupils may find the free materials and videos on the [Perse Research website](#) a helpful way to begin their exploration. We can’t wait to see the ideas that come through in the submissions!”

You can find full details of the competition and how to enter on our [Perse Research website here](#).

Entries should be submitted via our online form by the closing date of 5pm on **Friday 9 January 2026**.

If you are interested please contact Mr Monaghan for help and support





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Woldgate Art Dept. Photography Competition 2025

Theme:

"NATURAL FORMS"

This could include, leaves, plants, flowers, shells, landscapes, stones, fossils, seaweed, insects, fruit and vegetables etc .

Be creative, look at the utilization of shapes, contours, and structures photography can be black and white, sepia or colour. All photographs must be your own work and no bigger than A4.



How to enter

All entries must be hard copies to be handed in to the reception/ pupil reception by the **30th January 2026**.

The competition is open to all pupils and students, staff and parents.

Entries will be judged by the Headteacher.

Art prizes awarded to 1st, 2nd & 3rd place for pupils, 1st prize to staff and parents.